

12

Anti-King's Indian Systems

Build active play when White avoids the full e4 center



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

Use the KID setup intelligently against London, Torre, Barry, and related systems.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 067 | PAGE 4

Decode: London structure*Attack the center that exists, not the one you expected.*

LESSON 068 | PAGE 8

Play: London structure*Attack the center that exists, not the one you expected.*

LESSON 069 | PAGE 12

Decode: Torre with Bg5*When White develops modestly, claim the center modesty leaves available.*

LESSON 070 | PAGE 16

Play: Torre with Bg5*When White develops modestly, claim the center modesty leaves available.*

LESSON 071 | PAGE 20

Decode: Barry and 150-style attack*Similar piece setups can demand different plans when one pawn is missing.*

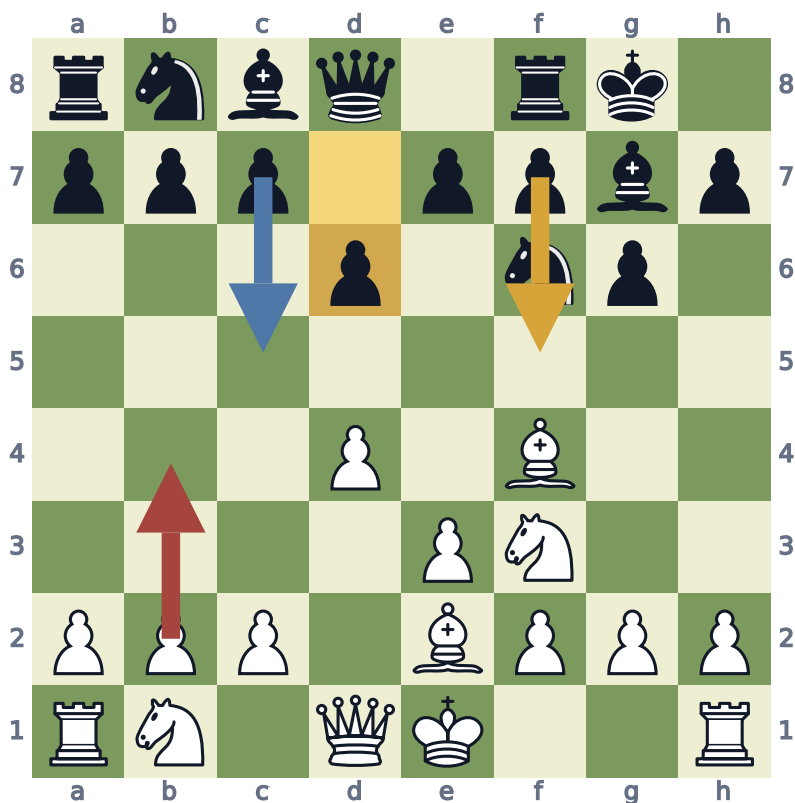
LESSON 072 | PAGE 24

Play: Barry and 150-style attack*Similar piece setups can demand different plans when one pawn is missing.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

Use the KID setup intelligently against London, Torre, Barry, and related systems.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: London structure



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Without c4 and e4, White gives Black more freedom to prepare ...e5 and to challenge the center directly.

DECISION RULE

Do not spend tempi on a KID maneuver designed for a center White never built.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...e5, ...Nh5, or ...c5 according to White's support of d4 and the bishop's retreat squares.

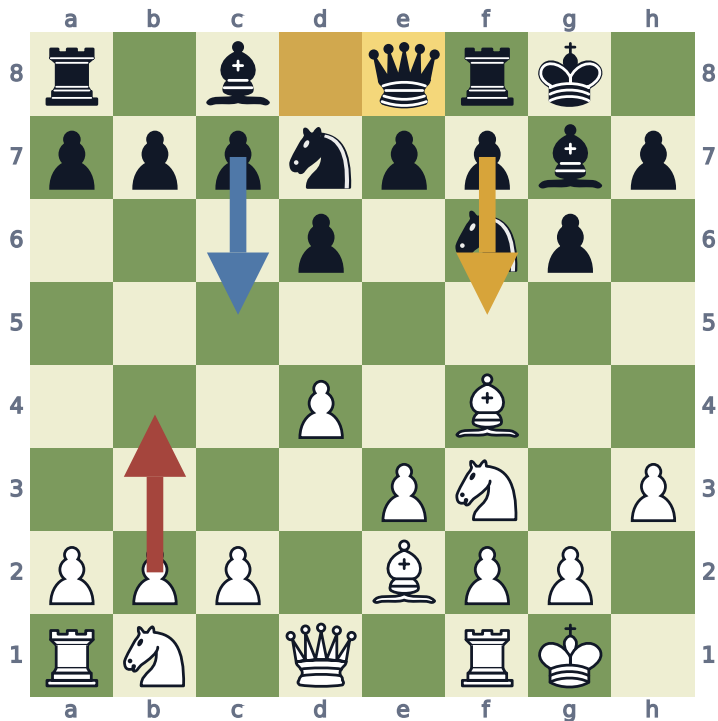
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants a stable setup, c3, Nbd2, and sometimes h3 or Ne5.

MEMORY RULE | Attack the center that exists, not the one you expected.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Without c4 and e4, White gives Black more freedom to prepare ...e5 and to challenge the center directly.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use ...e5, ...Nh5, or ...c5 according to White's support of d4 and the bishop's retreat squares.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White wants a stable setup, c3, Nbd2, and sometimes h3 or Ne5.

FAILURE MODE

A universal setup becomes passive when it ignores the missing central pawn.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Do not spend tempi on a KID maneuver designed for a center White never built. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

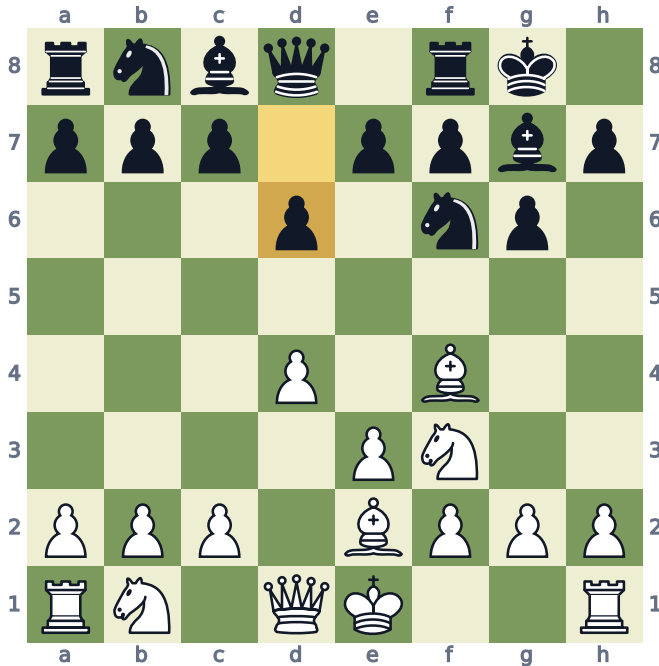
RULE | Attack the center that exists, not the one you expected.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. h3 Qe8



- Bf4: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- e3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Without c4 and e4, White gives Black more freedom to prepare ...e5 and to challenge the center directly.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Do not spend tempi on a KID maneuver designed for a center White never built. White's resistance is: White wants a stable setup, c3, Nbd2, and sometimes h3 or Ne5. The line fails as a template when: A universal setup becomes passive when it ignores the missing central pawn.

STORE THIS | Attack the center that exists, not the one you expected.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

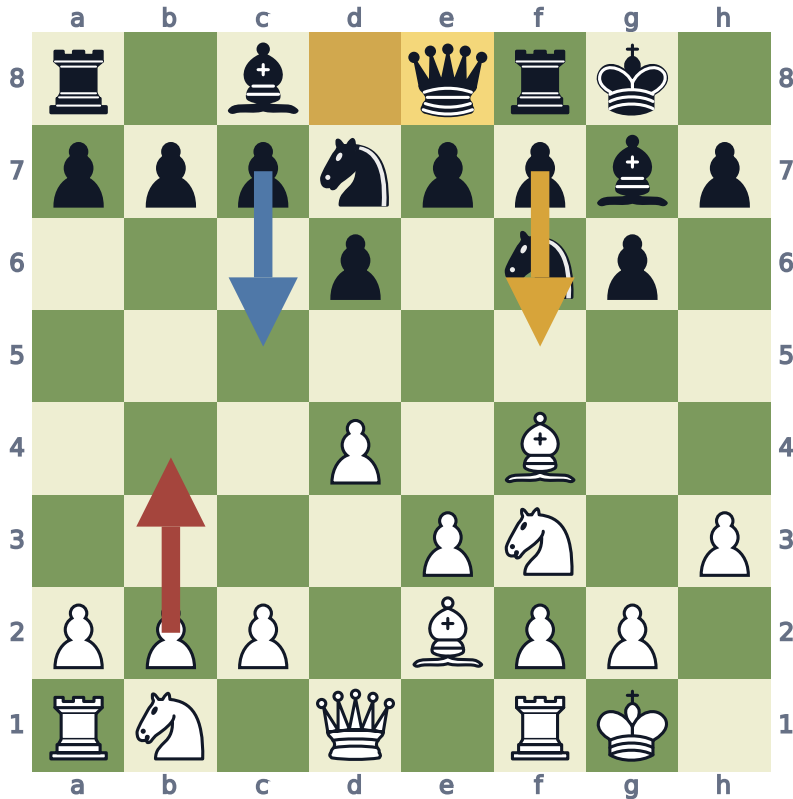
1. Without c4 and e4, White gives Black more freedom to prepare ...e5 and to challenge the center directly. 2. Use ...e5, ...Nh5, or ...c5 according to White's support of d4 and the bishop's retreat squares. 3. White wants a stable setup, c3, Nbd2, and sometimes h3 or Ne5. 4. Do not spend tempi on a KID maneuver designed for a center White never built. 5. A universal setup becomes passive when it ignores the missing central pawn.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: London structure



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

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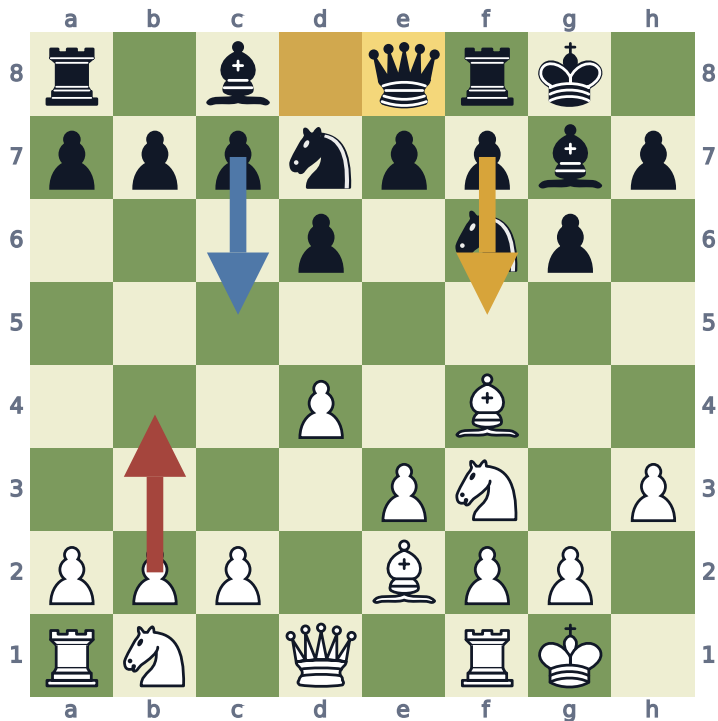
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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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FAILURE MODE

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Ask: Do not spend tempi on a KID maneuver designed for a center White never built. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

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Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. h3 Qe8



- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- h3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Qe8: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Without c4 and e4, White gives Black more freedom to prepare ...e5 and to challenge the center directly.

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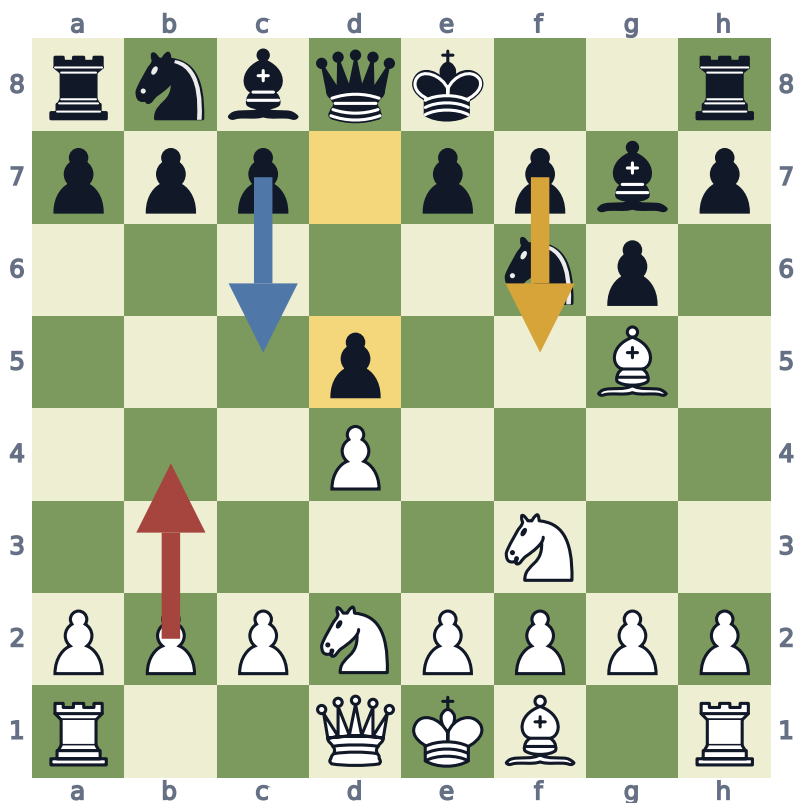
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. h3 Qe8

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Torre with Bg5

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The early bishop pin aims for simple development and e4, so Black occupies or attacks the center before White completes the plan.

DECISION RULE

Choose a central structure that makes Bg5 less relevant.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...d5 and ...c5 to gain direct central play and question the bishop's role.

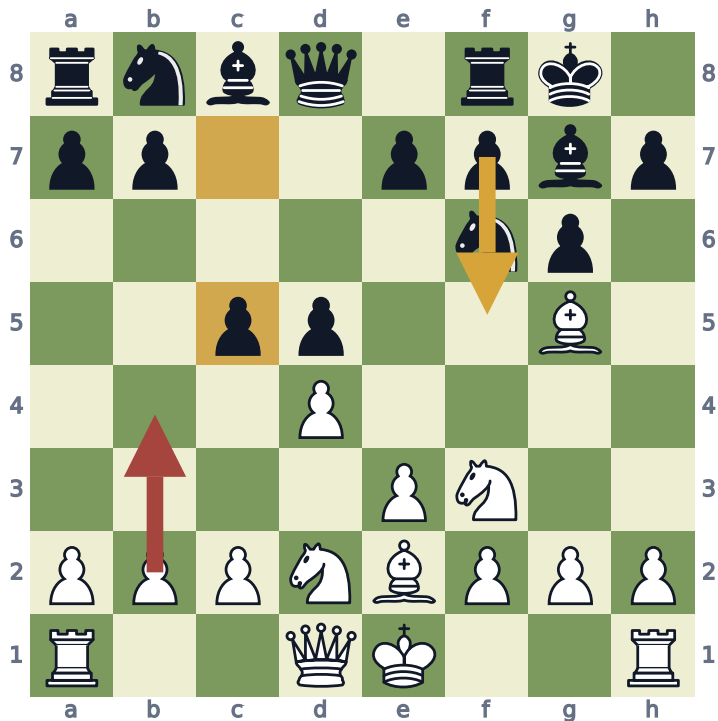
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White prepares c3, Bd3, and e4.

MEMORY RULE | When White develops modestly, claim the center modestly leaves available.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The early bishop pin aims for simple development and e4, so Black occupies or attacks the center before White completes the plan.

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White prepares c3, Bd3, and e4.

FAILURE MODE

Playing ...d6 and waiting can concede a comfortable version of White's system.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Choose a central structure that makes Bg5 less relevant. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

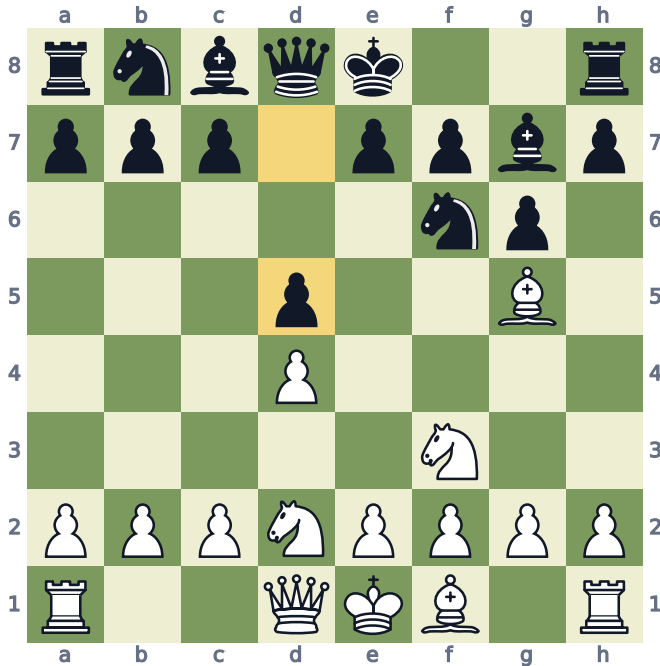
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bg5 Bg7 4. Nbd2 d5 5. e3 O-O 6. Be2 c5



- Nf3: White reroutes a knight toward f3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Bg5: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight toward d2; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- d5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The early bishop pin aims for simple development and e4, so Black occupies or attacks the center before White completes the plan.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Choose a central structure that makes Bg5 less relevant. White's resistance is: White prepares c3, Bd3, and e4. The line fails as a template when: Playing ...d6 and waiting can concede a comfortable version of White's system.

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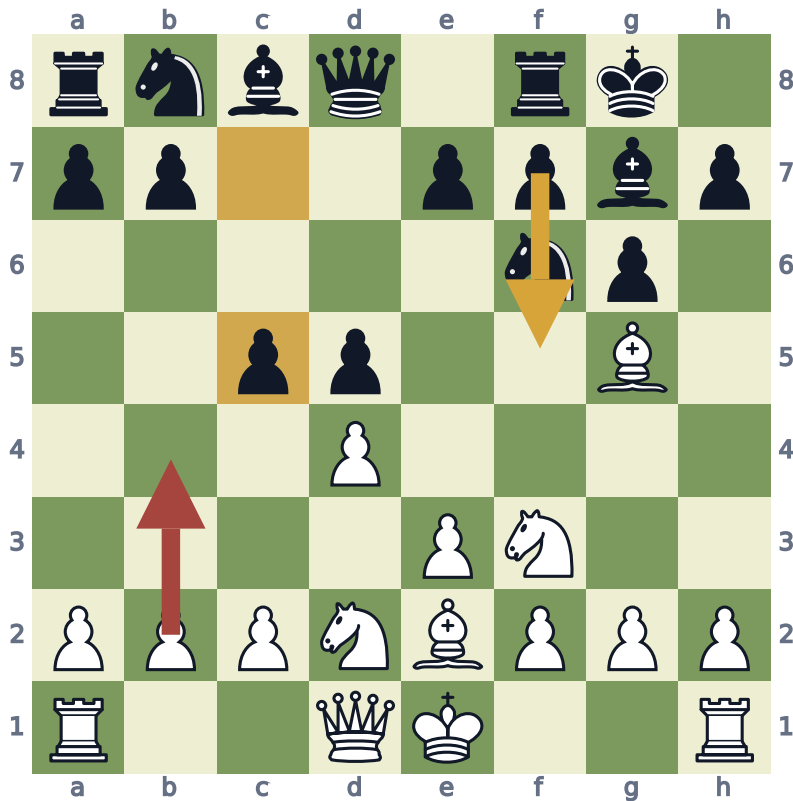
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 8 plies from memory, then replay: 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bg5 Bg7 4. Nbd2 d5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Torre with Bg5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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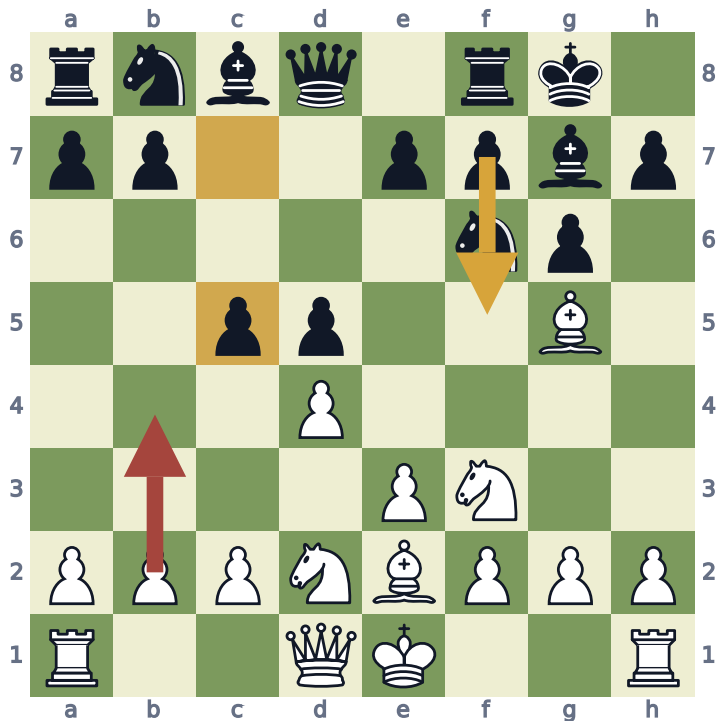
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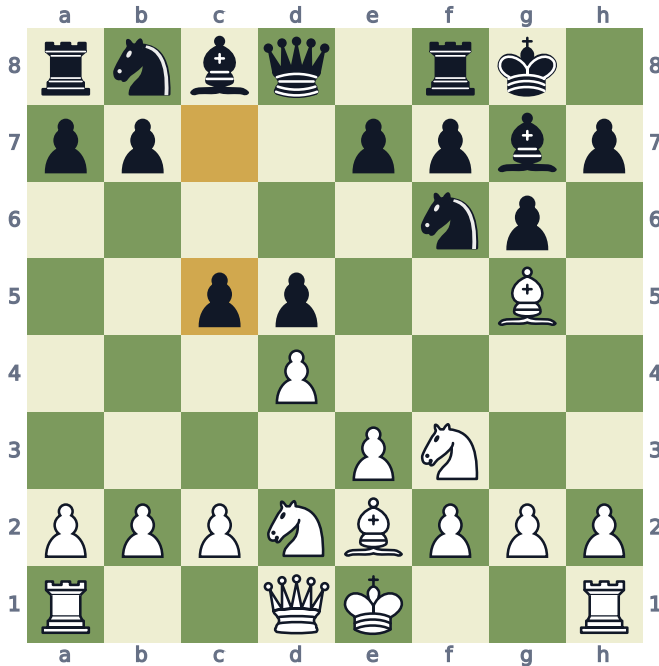
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bg5 Bg7 4. Nbd2 d5 5. e3 O-O 6. Be2 c5



- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight toward d2; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- d5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- e3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- c5: Black attacks the center from the flank and invites a Benoni-like transformation.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The early bishop pin aims for simple development and e4, so Black occupies or attacks the center before White completes the plan.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Choose a central structure that makes Bg5 less relevant. White's resistance is: White prepares c3, Bd3, and e4. The line fails as a template when: Playing ...d6 and waiting can concede a comfortable version of White's system.

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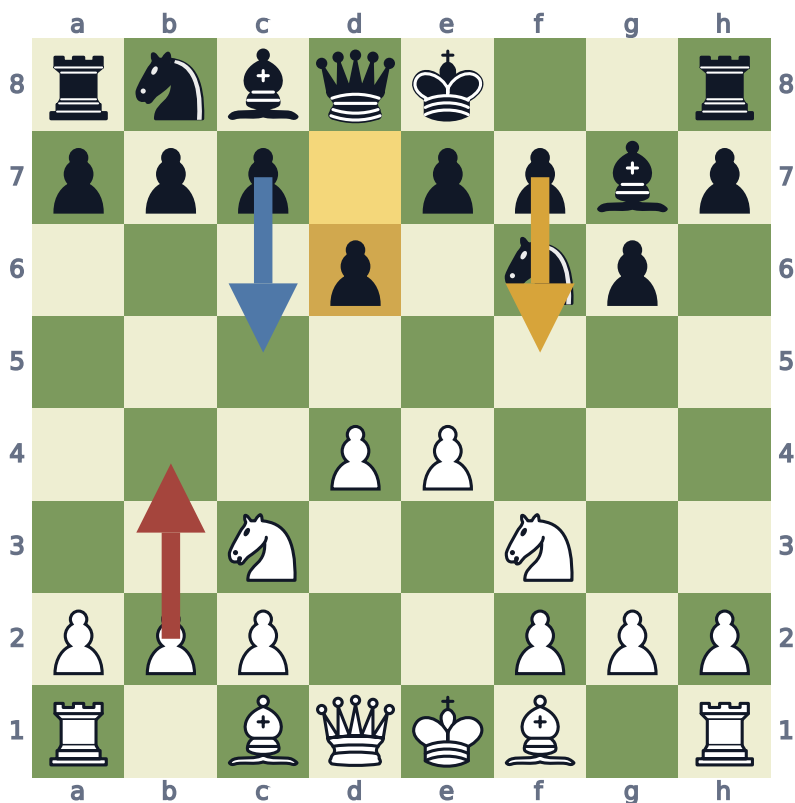
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nbd2 d5 5. e3 O-O 6. Be2 c5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Barry and 150-style attack

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

White builds an e4 center without c4 and often plans long castling and h-pawn play.

DECISION RULE

Treat the position as a Pirc-like attack with an extra d4 move, not as a closed KID.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Challenge with ...e5 or ...b5, create an escape route for the queen, and calculate opposite-wing races.

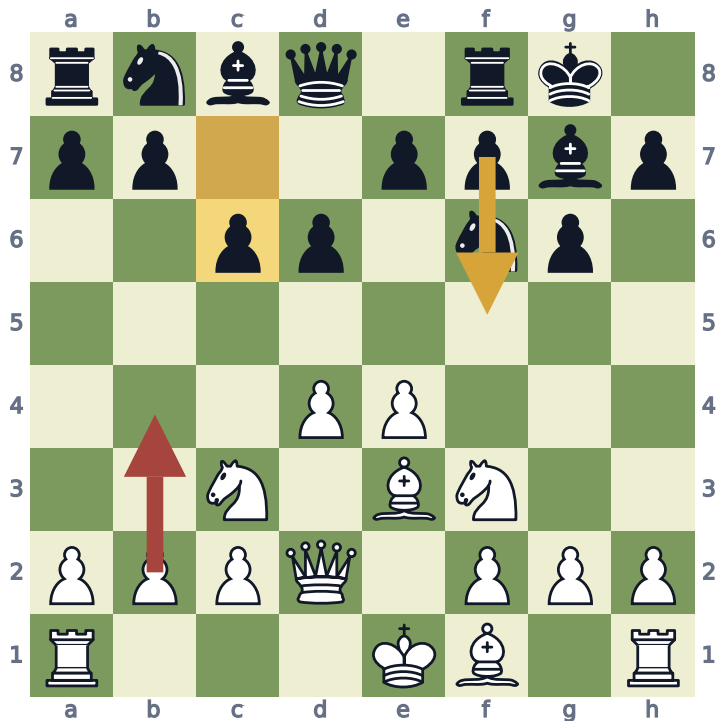
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants Bh6, long castling, and h4-h5.

MEMORY RULE | Similar piece setups can demand different plans when one pawn is missing.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White builds an e4 center without c4 and often plans long castling and h-pawn play.

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

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FAILURE MODE

Castling into a prepared battery without planning ...c6 or counterplay invites a direct attack.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Treat the position as a Pirc-like attack with an extra d4 move, not as a closed KID. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

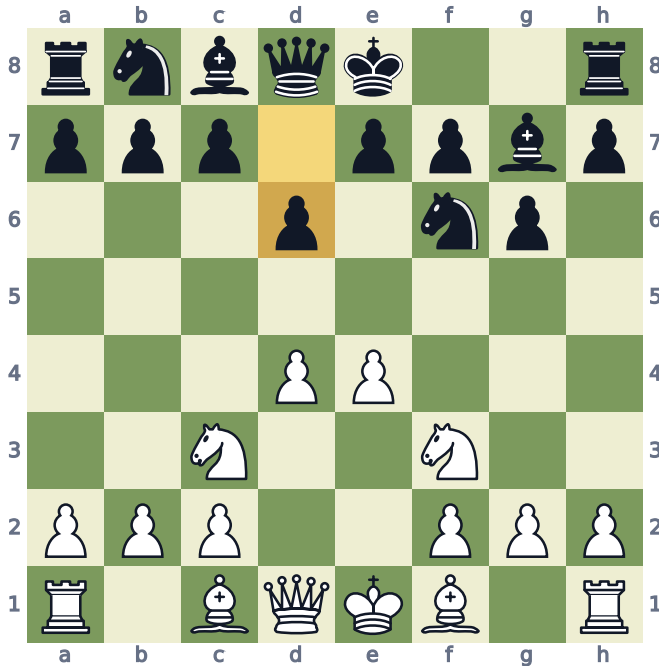
RULE | Similar piece setups can demand different plans when one pawn is missing.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be3 O-O 6. Qd2 c6



- Nf3: White reroutes a knight toward f3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight toward c3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- e4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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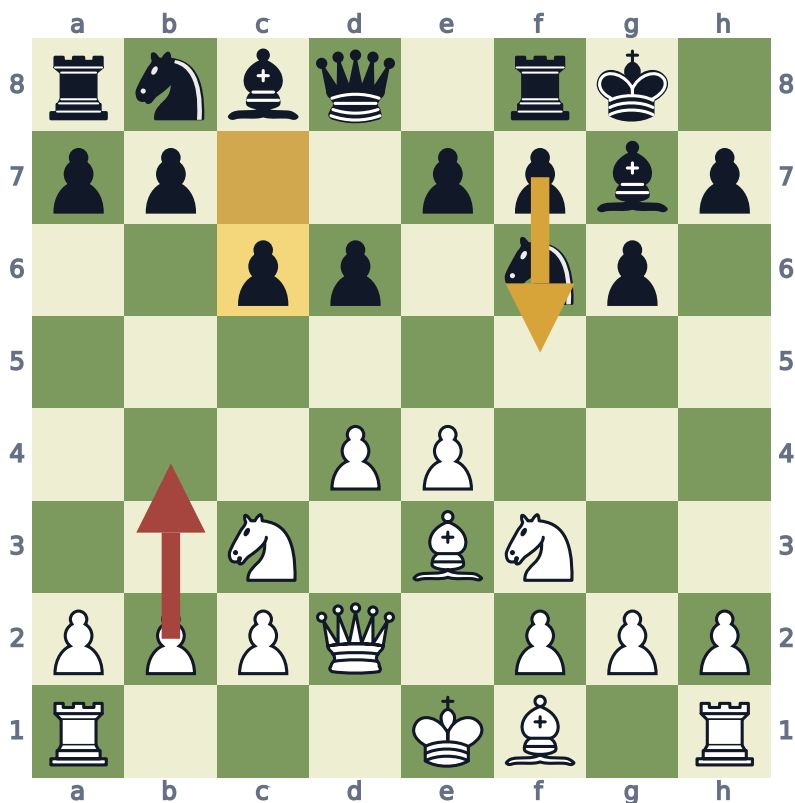
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 8 plies from memory, then replay: 2. Nf3 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Barry and 150-style attack



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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DECISION RULE

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SIDE TO MOVE

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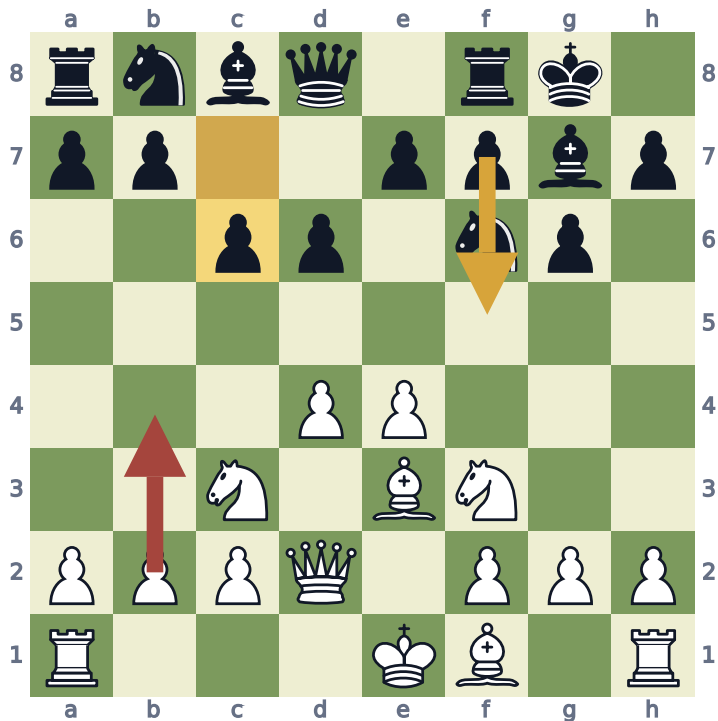
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

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Castling into a prepared battery without planning ...c6 or counterplay invites a direct attack.

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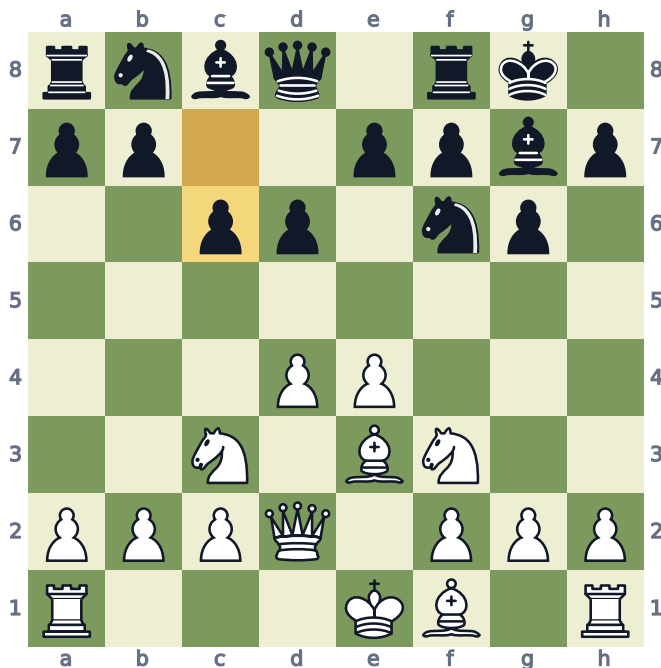
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
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ANSWER KEY

1. White builds an e4 center without c4 and often plans long castling and h-pawn play. 2. Challenge with ...e5 or ...b5, create an escape route for the queen, and calculate opposite-wing races. 3. White wants Bh6, long castling, and h4-h5. 4. Treat the position as a Pirc-like attack with an extra d4 move, not as a closed KID. 5. Castling into a prepared battery without planning ...c6 or counterplay invites a direct attack.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. e4 d6 5. Be3 O-O 6. Qd2 c6

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 067 Decode: London structure

Prompt: Do not spend tempi on a KID maneuver designed for a center White never built.

Recall: Attack the center that exists, not the one you expected.

LESSON 068 Play: London structure

Prompt: Do not spend tempi on a KID maneuver designed for a center White never built.

Recall: Attack the center that exists, not the one you expected.

LESSON 069 Decode: Torre with Bg5

Prompt: Choose a central structure that makes Bg5 less relevant.

Recall: When White develops modestly, claim the center modesty leaves available.

LESSON 070 Play: Torre with Bg5

Prompt: Choose a central structure that makes Bg5 less relevant.

Recall: When White develops modestly, claim the center modesty leaves available.

LESSON 071 Decode: Barry and 150-style attack

Prompt: Treat the position as a Pirc-like attack with an extra d4 move, not as a closed KID.

Recall: Similar piece setups can demand different plans when one pawn is missing.

LESSON 072 Play: Barry and 150-style attack

Prompt: Treat the position as a Pirc-like attack with an extra d4 move, not as a closed KID.

Recall: Similar piece setups can demand different plans when one pawn is missing.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

London structure

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. h3 Qe8

Decision: Do not spend tempi on a KID maneuver designed for a center White never built.

Memory: Attack the center that exists, not the one you expected.

CARD 2

Torre with Bg5

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bg5 Bg7 4. Nbd2 d5 5. e3 O-O 6. Be2 c5

Decision: Choose a central structure that makes Bg5 less relevant.

Memory: When White develops modestly, claim the center modesty leaves available.

CARD 3

Barry and 150-style attack

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be3 O-O 6. Qd2 c6

Decision: Treat the position as a Pirc-like attack with an extra d4 move, not as a closed KID.

Memory: Similar piece setups can demand different plans when one pawn is missing.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
067 Decode: London structure	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
068 Play: London structure	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
069 Decode: Torre with Bg5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
070 Play: Torre with Bg5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
071 Decode: Barry and 150-style attack	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
072 Play: Barry and 150-style attack	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.